

POLARSTAR KIDS

Bedtime Stories

Five quiet stories for the end of the day.

A collection for families with children ages 3 to 12.

A NOTE BEFORE YOU READ

These five stories were written for the slow part of the evening — the half-hour before sleep, when the world has finally gone quiet.

Each story is short. Read out loud, most take three to five minutes. They do not teach lessons. They do not solve problems. They simply give the child (and you) somewhere soft to land at the end of the day.

After every story you will find a page called “Together After the Story.” It holds three gentle questions — not a quiz, not homework. You can ask one, all three, or none. The silence after the question is part of the gift.

After that, a single “Quiet Activity” — a small invitation to do or notice one thing together before lights-out. Most take less than a minute.

There is no order. Read whichever story matches the mood tonight. Tomorrow, read another. Or read the same one twice. Children love what is familiar.

With warmth,

— ***Polarstar Kids***

LITTLE DREAMERS · AGES 3–5

Little Star

A tiny star learns that being small is not the same as being unseen.

About 3 minutes · read aloud, slowly.

High in the quiet sky lived a very little star. The other stars sparkled and laughed, but Little Star was so small she thought no one could see her.

One night, a child looked out of the window. The night was cold and the room felt dark. The child whispered, “I wish I had one tiny light, just for me.”

Little Star heard the whisper. She held her breath and shone as softly as she could. Not bright. Not loud. Just a small, warm light, like a candle far away.

The child smiled. “There you are,” they said. “I see you.”

Little Star learned something that night: a small light, given gently, is enough. You do not have to be the biggest to be loved. You only have to be here.

And every night after, when the room felt too dark, the child would look up and find her — small, calm, and exactly enough.

TOGETHER AFTER THE STORY

Three small questions. You can ask one, or all, or none. The silence after the question is part of the gift.

- 1 Did you ever feel small today? Did anyone notice you?
- 2 Who do you 'see' even when they are quiet?
- 3 What does it feel like when someone says, “There you are”?

Listen more than you respond. “I hear you” is always an answer.

Your Own Little Star

Draw a star on a piece of paper. Make it as small as you like. Choose one colour for it. Give it a name. Place it somewhere near your bed — so when the room feels too dark, you remember: even a small light is enough.

There is no right way to do this. Doing it slowly is enough.

LITTLE DREAMERS · AGES 3–5

The Moon Boat

*A sleepy boat made of moonlight carries quiet dreams across the
night sea.*

About 3 minutes · read aloud, slowly.

THE MOON BOAT

When the sky turns dark and the world begins to slow, a little boat appears on the sea. It is made of moonlight — silver and soft and very, very quiet.

The Moon Boat has no engine and no sail. It moves only when a child closes their eyes and breathes out, slow and warm.

Tonight, a small dream climbs aboard. It is the dream of a warm hand, a soft blanket, and someone gentle in the next room.

The Moon Boat rocks, just a little. The waves whisper, “Hush.” The stars lean down to look.

And while the child sleeps, the Moon Boat carries the dream across the calm, dark water — all the way to morning.

TOGETHER AFTER THE STORY

Three small questions. You can ask one, or all, or none. The silence after the question is part of the gift.

- 1 If you could place one dream on the Moon Boat tonight, what would it be?
- 2 What does your dream need to feel safe on the journey?
- 3 What sound does the sea make when it whispers, “hush”?

Listen more than you respond. “I hear you” is always an answer.

Three Slow Breaths

Lie down. Close your eyes. Imagine the Moon Boat rocking on calm water. Breathe in slowly — 1, 2, 3. Breathe out slowly — 1, 2, 3. Do this three times. With every breath out, the boat moves a little closer to morning.

There is no right way to do this. Doing it slowly is enough.

EXPLORERS · AGES 6–8

The Night Forest

A small explorer discovers that the forest at night is not scary — it is listening.

About 4 minutes · read aloud, slowly.

Mira had always loved the forest in the daytime. The leaves were green, the path was clear, and the birds sang loud songs. But at night, the forest looked different — taller, darker, full of shadows.

One evening, Mira's grandmother said, "Come. I want to show you something only the night forest knows."

They walked together, slowly. A small lantern swung between them. The trees were quiet, but they were not empty.

"Listen," Grandmother said. "The forest is not louder at night. It is just listening more carefully."

Mira stopped walking. She closed her eyes. She heard a leaf turn. A tiny breeze. The far, soft hoot of an owl who knew her name.

"The dark is not against you," Grandmother whispered. "The dark is paying attention."

Mira opened her eyes. The forest was still tall. The shadows were still long. But now they felt like company.

She walked home holding the lantern a little higher, no longer afraid.

TOGETHER AFTER THE STORY

Three small questions. You can ask one, or all, or none. The silence after the question is part of the gift.

- 1 What sound do you hear when you stop talking?
- 2 Is the dark scary — or is it just quieter than the day?
- 3 If the dark could speak softly, what do you think it would say?

Listen more than you respond. “I hear you” is always an answer.

One Minute of Listening

Before bed, sit somewhere comfortable. Close your eyes. Set a timer for one full minute. Do not talk. Do not move. Just listen. When the minute ends, name three sounds you noticed. (One of them might be your own breathing — that is allowed.)

There is no right way to do this. Doing it slowly is enough.

EXPLORERS · AGES 6–8

The Quiet Dragon

Most dragons roar. This one chose to listen — and changed a whole village.

About 4 minutes · read aloud, slowly.

THE QUIET DRAGON

In a village at the edge of a soft mountain lived a dragon who did not roar. He was tall and silver and a little bit shy. The villagers called him the Quiet Dragon.

Other dragons stomped through the valleys and shouted at the sky. But the Quiet Dragon liked to sit on his rock and listen.

He listened to the river. He listened to the wind. And, most of all, he listened to the children — because children, he said, often know what grown-ups have forgotten.

One day, a small boy came to the rock. The boy was angry. His hands were tight and his face was hot.

The Quiet Dragon did not ask anything. He just sat. And waited. And listened.

After a while, the boy began to talk. Then he began to cry. Then he became quiet too.

When the boy left, he was lighter. The Quiet Dragon had not said one word — but he had heard every single one.

That is how the village learned: sometimes the bravest thing a dragon can do is simply pay attention.

TOGETHER AFTER THE STORY

Three small questions. You can ask one, or all, or none. The silence after the question is part of the gift.

- 1 When you felt upset today, who listened to you?
- 2 Was there someone who needed YOU to listen?
- 3 What does it feel like when someone really, fully, hears you?

Listen more than you respond. “I hear you” is always an answer.

The One-Minute Listener

Tomorrow, choose one person — a parent, a sibling, a friend. When they speak, try to listen for one whole minute without interrupting. Do not plan your reply. Do not jump in. Just listen, like the Quiet Dragon. At the end, you do not have to say anything wise. “I hear you” is enough.

There is no right way to do this. Doing it slowly is enough.

DREAMWEAVERS · AGES 9–12

Aurin and the Lantern

*Aurin learns the difference between a light that shows the way and
a light that pretends.*

About 5 minutes · read aloud, slowly.

Aurin had walked for a long time. The path was older than the trees, and the trees were older than the village. In Aurin's hand, a small lantern glowed — not bright, but steady.

At a fork in the road, Aurin met a traveller. The traveller carried a beautiful lamp, much larger and louder than Aurin's. Coloured light spilled from it in every direction.

“Yours is so small,” the traveller said. “How can you see anything at all?”

Aurin smiled. “I do not need to see everything,” Aurin said. “I only need to see the next step.”

They walked together for a while. The traveller's lamp was magnificent. It lit up trees, rocks, and distant hills. But it also threw long shadows that confused the path.

Aurin's lantern lit only a small circle. But inside that circle, the ground was honest.

After many hours, the traveller's lamp grew tired and went out. The traveller sat down, suddenly afraid.

Aurin sat beside them, lifted the lantern, and said, “You do not need a bigger light. You need a closer one. Stay near me. We will go slowly.

One step is enough.”

And so they walked — not fast, not far, but together — and the small steady light was, in the end, more than enough.

TOGETHER AFTER THE STORY

Three small questions. You can ask one, or all, or none. The silence after the question is part of the gift.

- 1 When have you wanted a bigger light — a clearer answer, a longer view?
- 2 What does “the next step” look like for you tonight?
- 3 Is there a difference between a light that shows the way and a light that pretends?

Listen more than you respond. “I hear you” is always an answer.

One Honest Step

Stand up. Take three slow steps across the room. Notice each one — the heel touching down, the toes lifting, the balance shifting. Most days we walk a thousand steps without noticing one of them. Tonight: notice just three. Sometimes one honest step is the whole journey.

There is no right way to do this. Doing it slowly is enough.

THANK YOU FOR READING SLOWLY

*There are more stories on the way —
and a quiet world being built for them.*

Polarstar Kids is a painted home for bedtime stories, gentle activities and small family rituals — designed to be screen-down and ears-open.

prulesoul.site / kids-universe / polarstar

With warmth, from one quiet family to yours.